



Hackathons are messy, but will kindle your creative fire

Almost all hackathons will arrange for food and refreshments throughout the hack or will have made arrangement for vendors to set up shop inside the venue. There would be arrangements for catching a quick nap, but don't expect more than a few beanbags and pillows.

After the hacking period, you'll have the presentations. This is where you showcase what you've done to the judges and the participants and get to witness what the other teams have come up with. If the hackathon has good prizes, the competition will be fierce and the presentations will decide the prizes.

How to take advantage of hackathons to network and generate ideas

Once you have decided to participate in a hackathon, you need to ascertain what you expect out of the hack. For most people, it just to work with new people and learn new ideas. And most hackathons are about that. You won't find a better opportunity than a hackathon to meet people from different walks of life. You can use the hackathon to learn something new outside your domain or help someone new out with what they are doing. Every hackathon presents a new opportunity for a participant in terms of networking. Most hackathons offer something to the participants, it can be anything from priority at job interviews to internships and even proper salary packages. So, watch out for the hackathons from some companies if you're in the job market.